

MANUEL MUNOZ

Social Science Division ◇ New York University Abu Dhabi (NYUAD) ◇
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CURRENT AFFILIATIONS

Assistant Professor (visiting) in Business, Organizations and Society New York University Abu Dhabi	2025 -
Assistant Professor (Global faculty) in Business and Economics Universidad Autonoma de Bucaramanga	2025 -
Scientific Director Social Behavior and Experimental Economics Laboratory	2021 -
Research Fellow Luxembourg Institute of Socio-Economic Research (LISER)	2025 -

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Sociology University of Groningen (Netherlands)	2010 – 2015
MSc., Economics, <i>*with distinction</i> University of Valencia (Spain)	2008 – 2010
BSc., Economics Industrial University of Santander (Colombia)	2001 – 2006

PREVIOUS POSITIONS

Behavioral Scientist / Research Associate Luxembourg Institute of Socio-economic Research (LISER)	2023 - 2025
Adjunct Lecturer Social Science Division New York University Abu Dhabi	2022 – 2023
Behavioral Scientist Center for Behavioral Institutional Design (CBID) New York University Abu Dhabi	2020 – 2022
Postdoctoral Associate Social Science Division New York University Abu Dhabi	2017 – 2020
Postdoctoral Fellow (Juan de la Cierva) Economics Department University of Valencia	2016 – 2017

RESEARCH INTERESTS

My research focuses on organizational behavior and the behavioral economics of the workplace, with a particular emphasis on how nudges and social signals drive human capital development. I examine the behavioral and structural barriers to opportunity, investigating how selection biases influence talent management and decision-making in diverse organizational environments.

WORKING PAPERS

Closing Class Gaps with Simple Nudges: Experimental Evidence on Opportunity Allocation

Revise & Resubmit - Management Science (single authored)

The Recency Bias in the Attribution of Responsibility for Joint Work

Reject & Resubmit - Economic Journal (with A. Baranski)

The Penalty of Peer Endorsements in Talent Markets (single authored)

In preparation for Submission

Peer referrals Boost Take-Up of Valuable Opportunities (with M. Acampora)

In preparation for Submission

PUBLISHED PAPERS

Publicly Targeting Group Identities Impacts Take-Up of Educational Opportunities 2026

Forthcoming - Economic Journal (single authored)

Identity Change and Economic Mobility: Experimental Evidence 2024

Games and Economic Behavior (single authored)

The Role of Personal and Impersonal Relational Contracts on Partner Selection and Efficiency 2023

Journal of Law, Economics & Organization (with E. Reuben)

Experimental Evidence Shows that Negative Motive Attribution Drives Counter-punishment 2023

Journal of the Economic Science Association (with N. Nikiforakis)

The Limits of Transparency in Reducing Corruption 2021

Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics (with D. Parra, L.A. Palacio)

Web of lies: A Tool for Determining the Limits of Verification in Preventing the Spread 2021

of False Information on Networks

Scientific Reports (with K. Makovi)

Integration and Diversity 2020

Experimental Economics (with S. Goyal, P. Hernández, G. Martínez, F. Moisan, A. Sánchez)

Collaborative Production Networks among Unequal Actors 2020

Network Science (with J. Dijkstra, R. Wittek, A. Flache)

Equilibrium Characterization of Networks under Conflicting Preferences 2017

Economic Letters (with P. Hernández, G. Martínez, A. Sánchez)

The Bargaining Power of Commitment: An Experiment on the Effects 2015

of Threats in the Hawk-Dove Game

Rationality & Society (with L. A. Palacio, A. Cortés)

Heterogeneous Network Games: Conflicting Preferences
Games and Economic Behavior (with P. Hernández, A. Sánchez)

2013

SELECTED WORK IN PROGRESS

Gender Bias in Job Referrals (with F. Moisan, E. Reuben)

Manuscript in preparation

Promoting Professional Development in Adult Learners (with J. Díaz)

Data collection stage

GRANTS AND FUNDING

Seed Grant - NYUAD (co-PI together with M. Molina and B. Rosche) 25,000 USD	2026
Diversity, Inequality & Experiments Grant - NYUAD (PI - single authored) 7,044 USD	2025
Innovation Projects Grant - LISER (co-PI together with B. Verheyden) 64,000 Euros	2024
Fonds National de la Recherche Luxembourg (CORE) (co-Investigator. PI: M. Morelli) 682,931 Euros	2024
Experimental and Participatory Research (ExPar) - Seed Grant (PI - single authored) 6,000 Euros	2024
Research Grants - Universidad Católica de Colombia (co-PI together with D. Parra and L. Palacio) 12,88 USD	2017
Ayudas Juan de la Cierva - Spanish Ministry of Economics and Competitiveness 60,000 Euros	2017
Traveling grant - Max Plank Institute for Human Development 1,500 Euros	2011

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Management and Organizations (NYU Abu Dhabi) *Average evaluation: 4.89/5.0	2025 -
Foundations of Leadership (NYU Abu Dhabi) *Average evaluation: 4.73/5.0	2025 -
Markets (NYU Abu Dhabi) *Average evaluation: 4.4/5.0	2025 - 2026

Strategic Goals - <i>Virtual</i> (U. Autónoma de Bucaramanga)	2022 - 2025
*Average evaluation: 4.7/5.0	
Strategic Goals - <i>Virtual</i> (Universidad de San Gil)	2024
*Average evaluation: 4.7/5.0	
Fairness (NYU Abu Dhabi)	2022 – 2023
*Average evaluation: 4.9/5.0	
Application of Theories (U. Groningen)	2011 – 2014
*Average evaluation: 3.3/4.0	
Social Networks (Evangelisches Studienwerk Villigst, Germany)	2015
*Average evaluation: 1.81 in 1-5 (<i>inverted</i> : 1 is highest)	

CONSULTING

Specialist consultant: Debiasing performance evaluations KPMG Middle East	2022 - 2023
Subject matter expert in Behavioral Sciences KPMG Middle East – Dubai Executive Council	2022

POLICY REPORTS & OTHER PUBLICATIONS

<i>An Experimental Evaluation of the Forever Fit Program</i> Policy Report - Department of Community Development Abu Dhabi, UAE (with N. Nikiforakis, E. Reuben, A. Dariel, U. Afzal)	2021
<i>Exploring Nudges to Promote Physical Activity Among Senior Adults in Abu Dhabi</i> Policy Report - Department of Community Development Abu Dhabi, UAE (with N. Nikiforakis, E. Reuben, A. Dariel, U. Afzal)	2020
<i>Physical Activity for Senior Adults in Abu Dhabi</i> Policy Report - Department of Community Development Abu Dhabi, UAE (with N. Nikiforakis, E. Reuben, A. Dariel, U. Afzal)	2020
<i>Promoting Physical Activity Among Seniors in Abu Dhabi: An Experimental Test of the “Forever Fit” Nudge</i> Journal of the Economic Science Association (with N. Nikiforakis, L. Alhyas, U. Afzal, A. Agiostratitis, E. Alfalacy, A. Dariel, M. Monney, E. Reuben)	2024

PhD SUPERVISION

Jhon Díaz (PhD student - U. Jaume I, Castellón)
Genesis Amaya (PhD student - LISER)
Reha Tuncer (PhD student - U. Luxembourg)
*Defended December 2025

SERVICE

Referee for: Organization Science, Management Science; Labor Economics; Games and Economic Behavior; European Economic Review; Experimental Economics; J. Economic Behavior &

Organizations; PlosOne; Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics; J. Economics Psychology; Theory & Decision; The B.E. Journal of Economic Analysis and Policy, Mathematical Social Science; Rationality & Society; Advances in Complex Systems

Conference Organization: Social Behavior and Experiments Meeting - Social Bee Meet Colombia (2026); International Symposium on Experimental Economics - NYU Abu Dhabi (2026), Social Behavior and Experiments Meeting - Social Bee Meet Luxembourg (2026); 14th Field Days - Experiments Outside the Lab (2025); International Symposium on Experimental Economics - NYU Abu Dhabi (2018), International Symposium on Experimental Economics - NYU Abu Dhabi (2017), Workshop on the Frontiers of Network Science - NYU Abu Dhabi (2017), Dynamics & Collective Phenomena of Socio-Economic Systems - U. Valencia (2009), International Meeting on Exp. Behavioral Economics - U. Granada (2008)

Seminar Organization: Seminar series on Ethics, Economics and Experiments - LISER (2023 - 2025); PhD mentoring group on experimental research - LISER (2023 - 2025)

Committees: Member of the Ethics Review Committee - LISER (2024-2025); Member of the competence center on Experimental and Participatory Research - LISER (2023-2025)

INVITED SEMINARS

- 2026. U. Autonoma de Bucaramanga.
- 2025. U. Konstanz, ESADE, U. Valencia, U. Castellón, Karlsruhe (KIT).
- 2024. U. Frankfurt, NYU Abu Dhabi, Utrecht U.
- 2023. LISER-Luxembourg, Loyola U. Córdoba, FAU-Nuremberg.
- 2022. U. Castellón, U. East Anglia, IMT Lucca.
- 2021. U. Paris Nanterre.
- 2019. U. Tilburg, LISER-Luxembourg, WZB-Berlin, Maastricht U.
- 2018. U. Cologne, Central Bank Colombia.
- 2015. UIS-Bucaramanga, UNAB-Bucaramanga.
- 2014. UIS-Bucaramanga, Maastricht U.
- 2012. U. Castellón, U. Utrecht.
- 2011. U. Valencia, Maastricht U.

CONFERENCES

- 2026. 3rd Esade Workshop in Behavioral and Experimental Economics; 1st Inequality Conference (NYU Abu Dhabi), Social Bee Meet Luxembourg (LISER)
- 2025. Workshop on the Frontiers of Network Science (NYU Abu Dhabi), 14th Field Days - Experiments Outside the Lab (Luxembourg).
- 2024. 4th Virtual Discrimination and Diversity workshop (UEA, U. Exeter, Loughborough U.), Advances with Field Experiments (LSE), 3rd Workshop on Field Experiments in Economics and Business (Tech. U. Munich), 4th Experimental Sociology Workshop (Online), 13th Field Days - Experiments Outside the Lab (Amsterdam U), WoBE@E on Governance and Behavior (Valencia)

- 2023.** iSee (NYU Abu Dhabi), Workshop on the Frontiers of Network Science (NYU New York), ESA World Meeting (Lyon), 2nd Workshop on Field Experiments in Economics and Business (Dusseldorf), Matterhorn Symposium on Behavior, Institutions and Cooperation (Brig), 5th Dondena Workshop on Public Policy (U. Bocconi)
- 2022.** iSee (NYU Abu Dhabi), BiNoMa workshop on Economic Networks (U. Navarra), Inaugural Meeting of the MENA Network of Experimental Social Scientists (NYU Abu Dhabi)
- 2021.** Bogotá Exp. Econ. Conf. (U. Rosario), 7th Annual Workshop on Behav. Game Theory (U. East Anglia, Norwich), 6th Behav. Econ. Policy Symp. (Maastricht U.)
- 2020.** ESA Global Conference.
- 2019.** Winter Experimental Social Sciences Institute (Abu Dhabi), ESA Asia-Pacific Meeting (Abu Dhabi), Workshop in the Frontiers of Network Science – WTFNS (Abu Dhabi), IMEBESS (Utrecht U.)
- 2018.** Bogotá Exp. Econ. Conf. (U. Rosario), iSee (NYU Abu Dhabi), Workshop on the Frontiers of Network Science (NYU Abu Dhabi), 4th Conf. on Network Science in Econ. (Vanderbilt U.), IMEBESS (E.U.I. Florence), ESA World Meeting (Berlin), 4th Annual Workshop on Behav. Game Theory (U. East Anglia, Norwich), 1st Workshop on Exp. Econ (UNAB)
- 2017.** IMEBESS (U. A. Barcelona), 1st Workshop on Industrial Econ. (U. Valencia), 2nd Annual Research Poster Day (NYU Abu Dhabi)
- 2016.** 26th Game Theory Festival (SUNY at Stony Brook, New York)
- 2013.** Annual Conf. of the American Sociol. Assoc. (New York), Pre-conference Rat. Choice Sec. (Am. Sociol. Assoc., New York)
- 2012.** U4 Workshop (University of Ghent), 23rd Game Theory Festival (SUNY at Stony Brook, New York)
- 2011.** 10th Workshop on Networks in Econ. and Sociol. (U. Utrecht), 3rd UECE Lisbon Meetings - Game Theory and Applications (U. Lisbon)
- 2010.** 2nd UECE Lisbon Meetings - Game Theory and Applications (U. Lisbon)
- 2009.** 6th Int. Meeting on Exp. & Behavioral Econ. (U. Basque Country), Dynamics & Collective Phenomena of Socio-Economic Systems (U. Valencia)

RESEARCH VISITS

- 2022.** Visiting Scholar, ESADE Business School (July - Aug)
- 2018.** Visiting Scholar, University of Cologne (June – July)
- 2014.** Visiting Scholar, Columbia Business School (April – May)
- 2013.** Visiting Scholar, Columbia Business School (August - November)

MISCELLANEOUS

Programming/Software: zTree, oTree, LaTeX, Python, HTML5, CSS

Languages: Spanish (native), English (proficient)

REFERENCES

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